

青山学院大学 経済学部 英語 過去問風 演習

金融市場 長文一本番想定 (大問1題・25分)

2026年5月26日

高校3年～既卒 (青山学院大学 経済学部志望)

英語 (長文読解・青学経済本番レベル)

Trillion 塾

Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) [配点 30 点]

Read the following passage on financial markets.

The rise of index funds has been one of the quietest revolutions in modern finance. (A) An index fund is a type of mutual fund that simply tracks a market benchmark — such as the S&P 500 — rather than trying to beat it through active stock selection. Pioneered by John Bogle of Vanguard in 1975, this approach was initially mocked by Wall Street as "settling for average."

The mockery did not age well. Decades of evidence have demonstrated that the vast majority of actively managed funds underperform their benchmarks over long time horizons. (B) After accounting for fees, around 85 percent of professional fund managers fail to beat a simple index fund over a fifteen-year period.

Why is this? Three factors stand out. First, markets are remarkably efficient at incorporating information; consistently identifying mispriced securities is exceptionally difficult. Second, active management requires high fees, which compound dramatically over decades. Third, even when managers do beat the market for a few years, sustaining that performance is rare.

The shift to index investing has been seismic. (C) Today, more than 40 percent of US equity fund assets are held in index products, up from less than 5 percent in 1990. For ordinary investors, the implications are clear: a low-cost, diversified index fund, held patiently for decades, typically outperforms the elaborate strategies of expensive financial advisors.

However, critics raise concerns. As index funds grow, fewer dollars are devoted to actually analyzing companies and pricing them accurately. Some economists worry that markets could become less efficient if index investing dominates entirely. The debate continues, but for now, the index fund remains one of the most powerful tools available to individual investors.

Notes:

index fund — インデックスファンド

benchmark — 基準指数

underperform — 下回る

Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) — Questions

Q1 1

What is an index fund according to underlined sentence (A)?

- ① A fund that tries to beat the market through stock selection.
- ② A mutual fund that tracks a market benchmark like the S&P 500.
- ③ A fund managed by Wall Street insiders.
- ④ A type of cryptocurrency.

Q2 2

According to underlined sentence (B), what percentage of active fund managers fail to beat a simple index fund over 15 years (after fees)?

- ① About 50%
- ② About 85%
- ③ About 95%
- ④ About 30%

Q3 3

Which is NOT one of the three reasons given for why index funds outperform?

- ① Markets are efficient at pricing
- ② Active management has high fees
- ③ Sustained outperformance by managers is rare
- ④ Index funds are tax-free

Q4

4

What change is described in underlined sentence (C)?

- ① Index funds held more than 40% of US equity fund assets today, up from less than 5% in 1990.
- ② Index funds have declined since 1990.
- ③ Index funds are illegal in the US.
- ④ Most investors prefer active management.

Q5

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What concern do critics raise about index fund growth?

- ① That index funds are too expensive.
- ② That with fewer dollars devoted to analyzing companies, markets could become less efficient.
- ③ That index funds are illegal.
- ④ That index funds make people too wealthy.

Q6

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Who pioneered index funds?

- ① Warren Buffett
- ② John Bogle of Vanguard, in 1975
- ③ Goldman Sachs
- ④ The Federal Reserve

解答・解説

問	解答	解説
1	②	【正解】 ② 下線部 (A) と一致。
2	②	【正解】 ② 下線部 (B) 「around 85 percent」 と一致。
3	④	【正解】 ④ 第 3 段落の 3 要因: 効率市場・高手数料・持続困難。「tax-free」は記述なし。
4	①	【正解】 ① 下線部 (C) 「more than 40 percent ... up from less than 5 percent in 1990」 と一致。
5	②	【正解】 ② 第 5 段落 「fewer dollars are devoted to actually analyzing companies ... markets could become less efficient」 と一致。
6	②	【正解】 ② 第 1 段落 「Pioneered by John Bogle of Vanguard in 1975」 と一致。